14 Political Divisions of Western India

Topics covered

- Summary of information
- Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, UTs of Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu

1. Read the given map and fill in the blanks.
   The states are:

   R.....

   G.....

   M.....

   G.....

2. Find the union territories of Dadra Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

3. Talk about the natural regions in which these states and union territories lie.

As you can see, the states of western India have very varied geography. The weather is also not the same in these states. Rajasthan, Gujarat and some parts of Maharashtra do not get much rain, whereas Goa and some parts of Maharashtra get a lot of rain in the monsoon. The table gives you a quick view of these states and union territories.

State/UT	Capital and some cities	Rivers	Natural vegetation	Crops	Occupation
Rajasthan	Jaipur—capital, Mt Abu, Udaipur, Jaisalmer	Luni, Banas, Banganga	Thorny shrubs and desert vegetation	Bajra, pulses, jowar, cotton, tobacco, oilseeds and vegetables where there is canal water	Farming, cattle rearing, textiles, working in factories, marble work and handicrafts
Gujarat	Gandhinagar—capital, Ahmadabad, Porbander, Anand	Narmada, Tapi, Sabarmati	Scrub forests, teak and gum trees and papyrus plants	Oilseeds, cotton, bajra	Farming, working in factories and offices, salt making and handicrafts
Daman and Diu	Daman—capital, Diu	Daman Ganga		Rice, ragi, beans, bajra coconuts	Farming, fishing, salt making
Dadra and Nagar Haveli	Silvassa—capital	Daman Ganga		Rice, ragi, wheat, sugar cane	Farming, timber production
Maharashtra	Mumbai—capital, Pune, Nashik, Nagpur, Lonavala, Mahabaleshwar	Tapi, Narmada, Godavari, Krishna	Some forests, bamboo and mango trees, mangrove forests and thorny vegetation	Rice, sugar cane, oilseeds, groundnuts, cotton	Farming, working in offices and factories, working in the film industry
Goa	Panaji—capital, Marmagao, Madgaon	Mandovi, Zuari	Light forests and coconut trees along the coastline	Coconuts, cashew, rice, ragi	Agriculture, forestry, mining, fishing, tourism industry

RAJASTHAN

Capital and other cities: The state has Jaipur as its capital. It is also called the 'Pink City' because of the buildings that are painted in this colour. Other cities are Mt Abu, known for its Dilwara temples, Jodhpur, Udaipur and Jaisalmer, known for old palaces.

The Dilwara Jain temples are famous for their beautiful carved marble work.

Rivers: The river Luni starts from the Aravalli Range, flows through Rajasthan and ends in the extreme west of the region. The Banas and the Banganga are other rivers here. Man-made canals bring water from the rivers of Punjab to **irrigate** (water) fields to grow crops.

The camel fair at Pushkar in October/ November each year is a big event with thousands of camels and other cattle.

Natural vegetation: Most of the vegetation is thorny shrubs. There are hardly any trees except in small parts at the foot of the Aravalli Hills.

Crops: Grains like bajra and jowar are grown. Pulses, oilseeds, cotton and tobacco are other crops grown here. In the places where water is brought by canals, vegetables are also grown.

Occupation: Most of the rural people are farmers. Textiles, handicrafts, marble work, and camel rearing are other activities that people are engaged in. Many people also work in chemical and other factories.

GUJARAT

Capital and other cities: The capital city of this state is named after Mahatma Gandhi—it is called Gandhinagar. Porbandar is important as it is the birthplace of Mahatma Gandhi. Ahmadabad is a city that is well known for Gandhiji's ashram and for its cotton mills. The milk factory at Anand is known the world over for **cooperative** collection of milk.

Pink flamingoes in the watery marshes of the Rann of Kachchh—the state has a large variety of birds and animals. (Inset) A pink flamingo

Rivers: The rivers Narmada and Tapi flow across the state. The Sabarmati is another river that has Gandhiji's ashram on its banks in Ahmadabad.

Natural vegetation: There are only small scrub forests in the north-western region as much of the land has been cleared for cultivation and development. In some parts on the east there are teak and gum trees. The coastal areas have the papyrus plant from which a special paper is made.

Crops: Oilseeds, cotton and bajra are the main crops grown. Vegetables are also grown where the soil and water is suitable.

Occupation: As in most parts of the country, the people in the rural areas are engaged in farming. The state also has several industries such as oil and gas, textiles and chemicals. Therefore, many people also work here. Making handicrafts is another important occupation. In the salty marshes of the west coast, salt making is an important activity.

Stitching small mirrors on clothes is a skilled occupation of the women here. Notice them on the blouse of this tribal woman.

Discuss

- How is 2 October, Gandhi Jayanti, celebrated in your school?
- Why do you think Gandhiji's birthday is a national holiday?

UNION TERRITORY OF DAMAN AND DIU

Daman and Diu are one union territory, but the two places are separated by a stretch of the Arabian Sea. Daman is a coastal town near the southern border of Gujarat. Diu is an island off the southern coast of Gujarat. Daman is the capital of the territory.

Both places were old Portuguese **colonies** and then became a part of India several years after India became independent.

Diu Fort was built in the 16th century.

Daman is on an alluvial coastal plain and therefore good for growing crops. Rice, ragi, pulses and beans are grown in Daman. The river Daman Ganga flows through Daman.

A greater part of Diu is covered with sand and marsh. Bajra and coconuts are grown in Diu. Fishing and salt making are also important in Diu.

UNION TERRITORY OF DADRA AND NAGAR HAVELI

This union territory lies between Gujarat and Maharashtra. It is made up of about 70 villages. Silvassa is the capital. Like Daman and Diu, this was also an old Portuguese colony.

Most of the land is hilly and covered with forests. The Daman Ganga flows through this area and is used as a means of transport.

Rice and ragi are grown on terraced fields. Wheat and sugar cane are also important crops. Farming therefore is a major occupation. Timber production from the forests is another important activity.

MAHARASHTRA

The Gateway of India—built a century ago in honour of the visit of the British king and queen to Mumbai and other places

Capital and other cities: The huge city of Mumbai, which is the centre of trade and business in India, is the capital of this state. It is on the western coast and is different from other cities in the state. People from all parts of the country come to live and work here. Other places are Aurangabad, which has famous historical rock caves nearby, Nashik and Nagpur, known for grapes and oranges, and the hill towns of Mahabaleshwar and Lonavala. Pune is an industrial centre.

Marine Drive in Mumbai—a road curving along the sea

Rivers: The rivers Tapi, Narmada, Godavari and Krishna flow across the state.

Natural vegetation: The Western Ghats that run along the west coast have forests which have huge trees and small shrubs.

Bamboo and mango trees are also abundant. East of the Western Ghats, the area becomes drier so there is some thorny vegetation. The marshy lands along the coast have mangrove forests.

Crops: Rice, sugar cane, oilseeds and ground nuts are the main food crops. Cotton grows well in the black soil here.

Occupation: The state has people in a large variety of occupations. People in the villages are engaged in farming. In cities like Mumbai and Pune, people work in many offices and factories. The state has industries like textile making, sugar mills, the electronics industry, chemical factories and the film industry. Hundreds of people work in these.

Did you Know?

The dabba walas in Mumbai transport lakhs of tiffin carriers from homes to offices every day, punctually and without any error! Their work is so admired for efficiency that it is studied at Harvard University!

GOA

Capital and other cities: Panaji, the capital of Goa, is on the Mandovi River. Goa is one of the smallest states in India. It was also a Portuguese colony earlier. The other cities here are Marmagao and Madgaon.

An old-style family home influenced by the Portuguese—notice the red tiled roofs and open yard.

River: The Mandovi is the main river that flows through the state, the other being the Zuari.

Natural vegetation: There are light forests near the parts that are close to the Western Ghats. The rest of the land is sandy coastline that has coconut trees.

Crops: Coconuts grow along the coast. Other crops are cashew, rice and ragi.

Occupation: Agriculture, forestry and mining are the main occupations. Fishing is also common. Several people also work in the hotel industry and related jobs, as the place is a popular tourist spot.

The Basilica of Bom Jesus (good Jesus) has a casket with the preserved body of St Francis Xavier, a famous Christian monk from Europe.

Think and answer

Why is fish an important part of the diet of the people of Goa and coastal Maharashtra?

Values and Life Skills

Many people come from different states to work in the factories and offices in big cities.

- What would the differences be amongst these people?
- What can we learn by living in a community that is made up of different kinds of people?

REMEMBER

1. Some areas do not get much rain, whereas in others there is a lot of monsoon rain.
2. The natural vegetation varies because of differences in climate and geography.
3. Agriculture and fishing are major occupations in the rural areas.
4. All states have some industries that provide employment to people.

NEW WORDS

Irrigate	supply water to an area of land so that crops will grow
Cooperative	a business owned and run jointly by a group of people, with profits or benefits shared among them
Colony	a country or area under the full control of another country and occupied by its people

EXERCISES

A. Brain teaser

If 1 stands for A, 2 for B, 3 for C and so on until 26 which stands for Z—find the words here and write a sentence about each.

1. 16+1+14+1+10+9
2. 13+21+13+2+1+9
3. 10+1+9+16+21+18
4. 7+1+14+4+8+9+14+1+7+1+18

B. Write true or false.

1. Cashew grows well in Rajasthan.
2. Anand is known for its peanut production.
3. Daman and Diu were old Chinese colonies.
4. Dadra and Nagar Haveli has forested land.
5. Aurangabad is well known for nearby historical sites.

C. Match the following.

States/UT	Rivers
Rajasthan	Sabarmati
Maharashtra	Daman Ganga
Gujarat	Mandovi
Dadra and Nagar Haveli	Luni
Goa	Tapi

D. Fill in the blanks.

1. Oilseeds grow well in the dry states of ..... and ..... .
2. The ..... are beautiful birds found in the salt marshes of Gujarat.
3. Coconut trees grow well in the dry states of ..... and ..... .
4. An important nut grown in Maharashtra is ..... .
5. The marshy lands have ..... forests.
6. The Basilica of Bom Jesus is a holy place in ..... .

E. Answer the following questions.

1. Why is it possible to grow vegetables in Rajasthan?
2. What are some of the important occupations in Gujarat?
3. Why do many people come to Mumbai to work?
4. Why do the union territories of this region have Portuguese influence?
5. Goan food uses a lot of coconut. Why do you think this is so?

TP THINGS TO DO

A. Picture study

Find out more about these:

1.

2.

3.

4.

1. Hawa Mahal, Jaipur
2. Warli painting from Maharashtra
3. Charkha or spinning wheel
4. Cashew fruit

B. On your own

1. Why do we feel sticky near coastal areas?
   You will need: (a) a dry napkin (b) a wet napkin with water squeezed out (c) a wet napkin

Do as follows:

- Wash your face and wipe it with napkin 1. My face feels ..... .
- Wash your face and wipe it with napkin 2. My face feels .....
- Wash your face and wipe it with napkin 3. Now my face feels

..... .

The air in the coastal areas is like the third napkin that is wet and cannot absorb any more water. That is why we feel sticky in humid areas.

2. Find out the name of the popular brand from Gujarat that is famous for its milk and milk products.

C. In a group

Many people work as a team with film stars and directors to make a film. In groups of four, make a list of who they are and discuss the work they do. Read the credits at the end of a film to know the different kinds of work. (Hint: stuntmen, make-up person etc.)

WEBLINK

Mumbai dabbawala: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vrKFu9D6h2o (accessed on 27 July 2017)